Effective Date:
March 1, 2026

Background:
The FPLs and maintenance needs standards are used to determine eligibility for Medi-Cal programs and are adjusted annually to reflect changes in the cost of living.

The statewide Average Private Pay Rate (APPR) for Nursing Facility Level of Care (NFLOC) services is used to calculate a Period of Ineligibility (POI) when an institutionalized customer transfers non-exempt property for less than fair market value.

The Minimum Monthly Maintenance Needs Allowance (MMMNA) and Community Spouse Resource Allowance (CSRA) are used to calculate allocations in Spousal Impoverishment determinations.

The Supplemental Security Income/State Supplementary Payment (SSI/SSP) grant levels, In-Kind Support and Maintenance (ISM) values, Federal Benefit Rate (FBR), SSI Standard/Parent Allocation amounts, and Pickle Disregard Chart are used to compute Pickle Program eligibility.

The Tuberculosis (TB) income standard and standard child allocation are used in eligibility evaluations for the TB program who are ineligible to other Medi-Cal programs and whose income falls within specific limits.

Purpose:
To provide 2026 FPL, APPR, MMMNA, CSRA, SSI/SSP grant levels, ISM, FBR values, TB standards and procedures.

Policy:
The effective dates for the 2026 FPL values below are based on the coverage groups listed. Refer to Medi-Cal Program Guide (MPG) 11.1A for the updated values.

Effective Date	Coverage Group
Retroactively to January 1, 2026	Modified Adjusted Gross Income (MAGI) methodologies and Medicare Savings Programs (MSP) with: • Qualified Medicare Beneficiary (QMB). • Specified Low-Income Medicare Beneficiary (SLMB). • Qualified Individual (QI-1) who do not receive Title II Retirement, Survivors, and Disability (RSDI) income.
Retroactively to March 1, 2026	MSPs with customers receiving Title II RSDI income.
Effective April 1, 2026	Aged, Blind, and Disabled (ABD) FPL programs and the 250% Working Disabled Program (WDP).

The Maintenance Needs Assistance Standards below are effective January 1, 2026.

Maintenance Needs	2026 Values
APPR	$14,440 per transfer
MMMNA	$4,067
CSRA	$162,660
FBR	• $994 for an individual. • $1,491 for a couple.
SSI Standard **Parent Allocation** **Standard Child Allocation**	• $994 for one ineligible parent living with a child. • $1,491 when both ineligible parents live with a child. • $497 maximum for each ineligible child.
Pickle Disregard/Multiplier and SSI Payment Values	Refer to MPG 11.1A
TB	$2,073

Procedure:

2026 FPL Increases

Use the increased 2026 FPL values when determining eligibility for:

- Denials and discontinuances back to the specified effective date for each coverage group.
- Requests from a beneficiary, their parent or legal guardian, or Authorized Representative (AR), to retroactively evaluate eligibility for:
  - Individuals eligible to Advanced Premium Tax Credits (APTCs) who did not enroll in a Qualified Health Plan (QHP) nor pay a premium.
  - Individuals with a Share of Cost (SOC).

Note: Individuals who had out of pocket expenses for covered medical or dental services and are re-determined eligible to either a lower or zero SOC with the 2026 FPLs may be eligible for retroactive medical out-of-pocket expense reimbursements. Refer to MPG 04.02.10J Beneficiary Reimbursement Process for more information.

APPR

Use the updated APPR values when determining a POI that occurs on or after January 1, 2026, due to a disqualifying transfer of property as referenced in MPG 09.07.01.

Do not calculate periods of ineligibility for disqualifying transfers made between January 1, 2024, and December 31, 2025.

MMMNA and CSRA

Use the updated MMMNA and CSRA figures when determining the spousal income and property allocation to the community spouse.

SSI/SSP Grant Levels, ISM Values, FBR, SSI Standard/Parent Allocation Amounts, and Pickle Disregard Chart

Use the updated 2026 values to calculate Pickle Program eligibility.

TB Income Standards, FBR, Standard Child Allocation
Use the updated 2026 values when determining eligibility to the TB Program.

Note: When determining retroactive eligibility for any of the above programs, use the FPLs and related charts for that month and year.

Automation Impact:
The SSI/SSP grant levels, ISM values, FBR, SSI Standard/Parent Allocation amounts, and Pickle disregard chart were updated in the California Statewide Automated Welfare System (CalSAWS) effective January 1, 2026. The 2026 FPL values were updated in CalSAWS on February 11, 2026, and a batch run was scheduled for February 28, 2026.

Exception lists will be shared with Family Resource Centers (FRCs) to identify cases that did not update during the batch run. FRCs must review and act on cases that did not authorize in the batch run; the lists will include instructions on how to process these cases. FRCs will be notified when the exception lists are available via the Management Reports SharePoint in the Medi-Cal Reports section.

References:
All County Welfare Directors Letters (ACWDLs) 25-29, 26-01, 26-02, 26-03 and 26-06.

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance on or by March 31, 2027.

Approval for Release:



Alberto Banuelos, Ph.D., Interim Director
Self-Sufficiency Services